

Chapter

Devaguru Brihaspati — Guru the Planet, the Guru Principle, and the Guru Who Leads Us to God



Introduction: The One Without Whose Grace No Work Succeeds

In the Indian tradition, the word "Guru" carries two meanings at once: on one side, **Guru the planet** among the nine Navagrahas, Devaguru Brihaspati (Jupiter); on the other, the **Sadguru**, the true master who leads the seeker to the Supreme. This discourse ties the two together. It begins with

the glory of the Guru that every seeker recognises from experience:

"The one without whose grace none of your work can succeed, whose being unfavourable renders even the auspicious yogas in your horoscope fruitless, and whose blessing can turn even an inauspicious period into an auspicious time — everyone wants the grace of such a supremely divine Lord Guru."

1. The Guru in Scripture and in the Words of the Saints

To describe the Guru's glory, the Shri Guru Gita is remembered. Its meaning: if God is displeased, the Gurudev saves you; but if the Gurudev is displeased, no other remedy works.

śīve ruṣṭe gurustrātā gurau ruṣṭe na kāścana

"When Shiva is displeased, the Guru protects; when
the Guru is displeased, there is no one."

— Shri Guru Gita

Sant Kabir Das said the same in simple words: if the Guru and God stand before you together, it is best to bow your head at the Guru's feet, for it is by the Guru's grace that one has the darshan of God.

**guru govind dou khaḍe, kāke lāgūm pāmya
balihārī guru āpane, govind diyo batāya**

"Guru and Govind both stand before me — whose
feet shall I touch first? I offer myself to my Guru,
who showed me Govind."

— Sant Kabir Das

2. Guru the Planet: Presiding Deity of Life's Auspicious Qualities

From the astrological point of view, almost all the qualities that make life meaningful are governed by a single planet:

"Education and knowledge, stability in life, honour and respect in society, wealth, a happy married life, children, good health, righteous work, peace of mind, spiritual progress and good company — all these make life meaningful. And the presiding deity of all these qualities is the planet Guru, that is, Devaguru Lord Brihaspati."

When Guru Is Balanced

"When Guru is balanced in the horoscope, we gain in life self-confidence, the grace of the devatas, clear guidance in every field, high position, prosperity, peace in the family, discernment, positivity, the finest devotion and depth in spirituality."

"In today's age, where confusion, adharma, greed and demonic forces are growing, it is the planet Guru that gives life the right direction."

When Guru Is Afflicted

The signs of a weak or afflicted Guru are also clearly described:

- Confusion in decisions and a lack of right guidance
- Failure despite effort, and instability
- Debt, and obstacles in education and marriage
- Health problems and needless struggle in life
- The auspicious yogas of the horoscope going to waste

But the description does not end in despair:

"But where there is a problem, there is surely a solution too."

3. The Remedy: Collective Guru Beej Mantra Sadhana

The solution is **chanting the Guru beej mantra**, especially collectively. The Antar Yog Guru Beej Mantra Sadhana, held in the presence of Acharya Upendra Ji, is described as a means of awakening the Guru principle:

"This online sadhana is a unique means of awakening the Guru principle in your life and becoming worthy of the Guru's divine grace."

The secret of the power of collective chanting is this:

"When thousands of seekers chant the mantra together online, the energy of crores of mantras resounds through the universe, and stability, clarity, success and the Guru's grace shower into the life of every seeker."

This sadhana goes beyond merely pacifying a planet:

"This is not just a sadhana for pacifying the planet Guru; it is a divine means of exalting the planet Guru in your horoscope and receiving the Guru's blessings in your life."

The sadhana is part of the global Navagraha chanting campaign that Acharya Upendra Ji began in May 2025; he himself has so far performed the chanting of more than five lakh Navagraha mantras, along with yajnas and abhishekas.

4. Why Bow to the Guru First?

Now Acharya Upendra Ji himself goes to the root of the question: if the Guru and the Supreme both stand before us, why bow to the Guru first?

"It is said that the Guru is Shiva and Shiva is the Guru. Because Shiva means the Supreme, and if the Guru and the Supreme come face to face, the scripture says: bow to the Guru first, to the Supreme afterwards."

The reason is that the Supreme creates the world and then hides himself:

"Because the Supreme does create everything, but after creating the world, he hides. It is said, isn't it — 'Veiled by yogamaya, I am hidden; I am not visible to people.' And the Guru appears before everyone and tells them where he is hiding."

Acharyaji is pointing here to the words of the Bhagavad Gita, where the Lord himself says that, being veiled by yogamaya, he is not visible to all:

nāhaṁ prakāśaḥ sarvasya yogamāyā-samāvṛtaḥ

"I am not manifest to all, veiled as I am by my
yogamaya."

— Bhagavad Gita 7.25

5. The Game of Hide-and-Seek and Guru Mauli

Acharyaji explains this deep truth with a childhood game:

"Just as all children play the game of hide-and-seeK.
There is one small child — the little 'limbu-timbu' one,
whom we call the 'kachcha biscuit' — and for a long
time he can't find anyone."

"So the other children enjoy it, but the mother feels bad.
Then the mother says, 'He's hiding there, over there!' So
he goes and catches him from behind the curtain. Then
the other children shout, 'Why did you tell him? We
were hiding so well!'"

And this is exactly the Guru's work:

"So exactly the same thing happens. The Supreme creates all this, then hides, and we keep searching and searching. And the Guru, the Lord, doesn't like this."

"He says, I had already reached there — Guru Mauli says, 'Arre, he's there, look over there!' Exactly this is the work."

With the word "Mauli" (Marathi for "mother"), Acharyaji shows the motherly form of the Guru, who cannot bear to see her smallest, most tired child losing the game, and simply tells the child where the Supreme is hiding.

6. The Purpose of the True Guru: Union with the Supreme

Today one can find a "guru" in every field. Acharyaji draws a clear distinction:

"Having a Guru in life is very important. Its purpose is union with the Supreme."

"As for the rest — make a big achievement here, do this, everything — for that you will find corporate gurus, you will find love gurus, you will find all the other gurus there are. Experts in every field — you will find law gurus."

"Not those. This Guru is God — the Guru of the devatas."

7. Brihaspati, Vachaspati, Brahmanaspati, Ganapati: The Marks of a Sadguru

The very names of the Guru of the devatas contain the marks of a true Guru:

"So that means Brihaspati. Brihaspati equal to Vachaspati, equal to Brahmanaspati, equal to Ganapati. So what does that mean — how should this Guru be?"

Vachaspati: Lord of Speech

"Brihaspati, Vachaspati — he should have control over his speech as well; he should have vak-siddhi. Such a Guru is called 'shrotriya brahmanishtha', isn't he."

Vak-siddhi means speech that is true and that comes to fruition. A **shrotriya** is one well-versed in the scriptures, and a **brahmanishtha** is one established in Brahman.

Brahmanaspati: The Capacity to Create a New Destiny

"And Brahmanaspati means you should have the capacity to create something. And create means your whole new destiny, a new life."

Ganapati: Lord of the Ganas

"And finally he should also be the lord of the ganas — one who has attained viveka-buddhi, who observes brahmacharya, and then who discerns joy and sorrow — all the qualities that Ganapati has, starting from subtle intellect."

"And finally, Ganapati is the very form of Omkar. So all that comes in — that is what is called Brihaspati."

Thus **Brihaspati** is not merely the name of a planet, but the name of the complete Guru who holds speech, creation, discernment and Omkar, the ultimate truth, all within himself.

Summary: Key Teachings

- 1 The Guru's grace is supreme:** if God is displeased, the Guru saves; but if the Guru is displeased, no remedy works.
- 2 The planet Guru presides over life's auspicious qualities:** education, stability, honour, wealth, marriage, children, health and spiritual progress are all linked to Brihaspati.
- 3 Where there is a problem, there is a solution:** for an afflicted Guru, chanting the Guru beej mantra, especially collectively, awakens the Guru principle.

- 4 **Bow to the Guru first:** the Supreme creates the world and hides in yogamaya; the Guru appears and tells us where he is.
- 5 **The Guru is Maui, the mother:** like the mother in the game of hide-and-seek, the Guru himself tells the tired seeker where the Supreme is.
- 6 **The true Guru's purpose is union with the Supreme:** you will find corporate gurus, love gurus and experts in every field, but the Sadguru is the one who unites you with God.
- 7 **The marks of a Sadguru are in Brihaspati's names:** Vachaspati (vak-siddhi), Brahmanaspati (the capacity to create a new destiny), and Ganapati (discernment, brahmacharya, subtle intellect, the form of Omkar).